Organism	Number of chromosomes (2n)
Adder's tongue fern (*Ophioglossum*)	1262
Horsetail *(Equisetum)*	216
Giant sequoia	22
Arabidopsis	10
Sugarcane	80
Apple	34
Rice	24
Potato	48
Maize	20
Onion	16
Haplopappus gracilis	4

Table 3.2 : Number of Chromosomes



Thomas Hunt Morgan (1933) received Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for his discoveries concerning the role played by chromosomes in heredity.

3.2 Linkage

The genes which determine the character of an individual are carried by the chromosomes. The genes for different characters may be present either in the same chromosome or in different chromosomes. When the genes are present in different chromosomes, they assort independently according to Mendel's Law of Independent Assortment. Biologists came across certain genetic characteristics that did not assort out independently in other organisms after Mendel's work. One such case was reported in Sweet pea ***(Lathyrus odoratus)*** by **William Bateson** and **Reginald C. Punnet** in 1906. They crossed one homozygous strain of sweet peas having **purple flowers** and **long pollen grains** with another homozygous strain having **red flowers** and **round pollen grains.** All the F_1 progenies had purple flower and long pollen grains indicating purple flower long pollen **(PL/PL)** was dominant over red flower round pollen **(pl/pl).** When they crossed the F_1 with double recessive parent (test cross) in results, F_2 progenies did not exhibit in 1:1:1:1 ratio as expected with independent assortment. A greater number of F_2 plants had purple flowers and long pollen or red flowers and round pollen. So they concluded that genes for purple colour and long pollen grain and the genes for red colour and round pollen grain were found close together in the same homologous pair of chromosomes. These genes do not allow themselves to be separated. So they do not assort independently. This type of tendency of genes to stay together during separation of chromosomes is called **Linkage.**

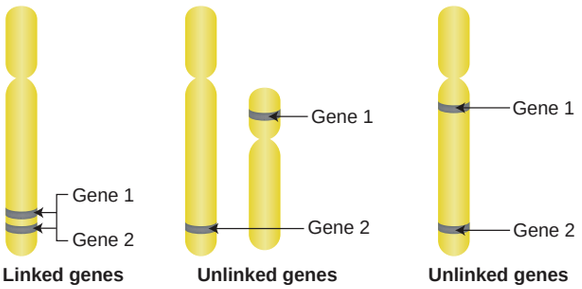


Figure 3.3: Arrangement of linked and unlinked genes on chromosome

Genes located close together on the same chromosome and inherited together are called **linked genes.** But the two genes that are sufficiently far apart on the same chromosome are called **unlinked genes or syntenic genes** (Figure 3.3). Such condition is known as **synteny**. It is to be differentiated by the value of recombination frequency. If the recombination frequency value is more than 50 % the two genes show unlinked. when the recombination frequency value is less than 50 %, they show linked. Closely located genes show strong linkage, while genes widely located show weak linkages.



Fossil Genes: Some of the junk DNA is made up of pseudo genes, the sequences presence in that was once working genes. They lost their ability to make proteins. They tell the story of evolution through fossilized parts.

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